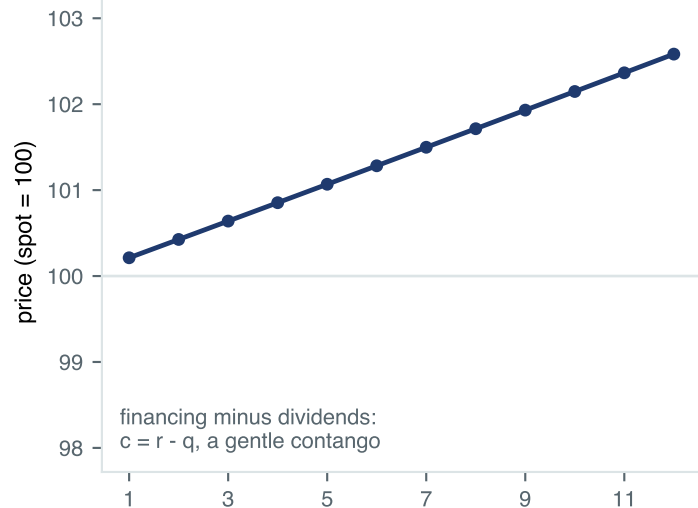
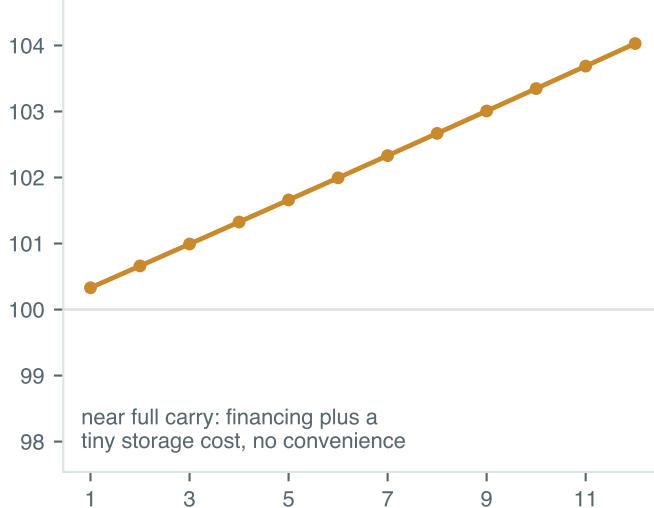


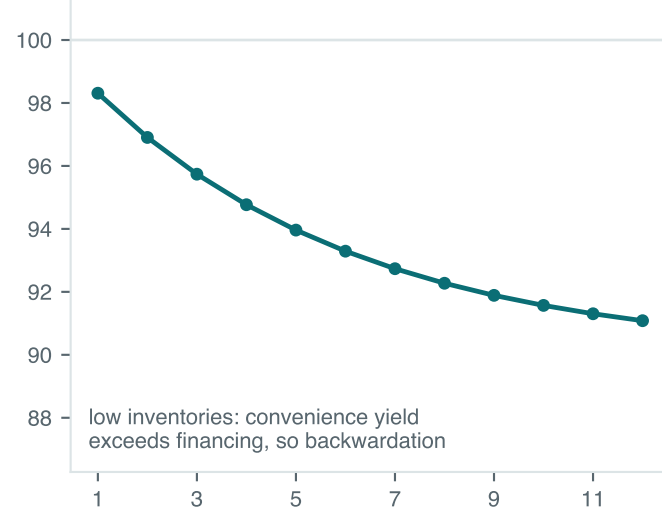
Equity index



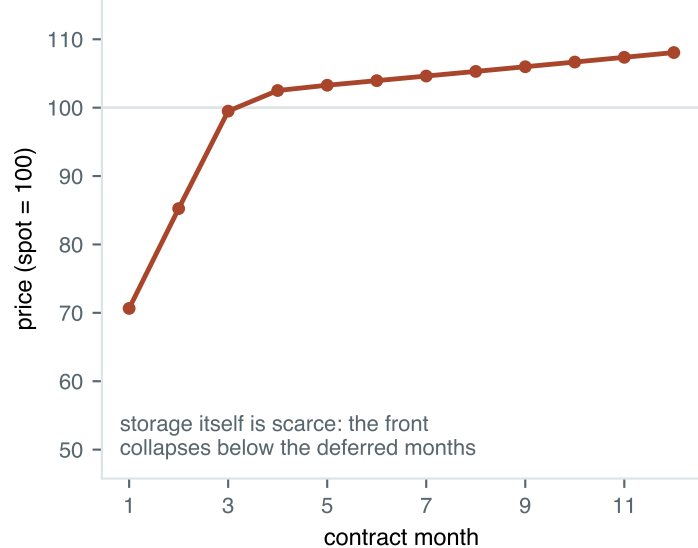
Gold



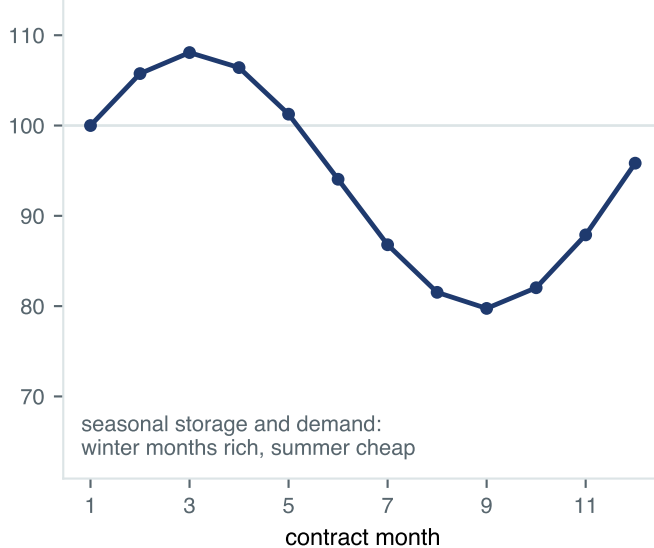
Crude oil, tight market



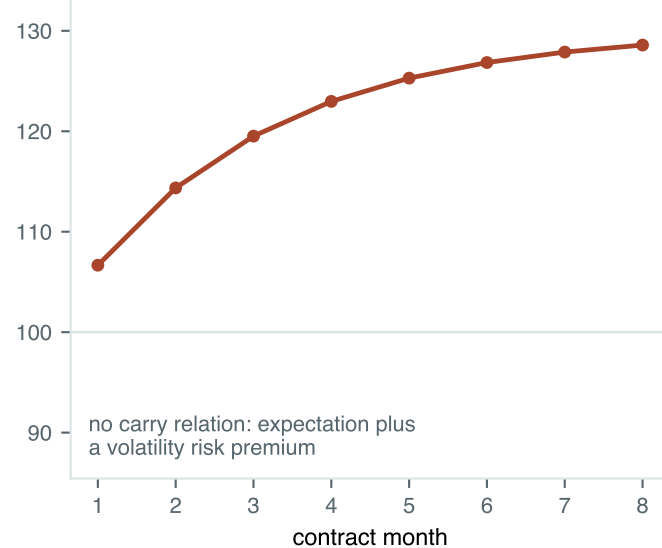
Crude oil, storage full



Natural gas (first month November)



VIX futures, calm market



Stylised shapes, not market quotes. In every storable market the slope is the net cost of carry: financing and storage push the curve up, income and convenience pull it down. The VIX has no such link, and its slope is mostly a premium paid to whoever is short.